Chapter One

Communication Skills

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Chapter One Outlines

- **Communication Concepts**
- **Essential Components of Communication**
- **Models of Communication**
- **Communication in Context:** ***Intrapersonal***, ***Interpersonal***, ***Group***, ***Public***, ***Mass***.
- **Types of Communication Skills:** ***Verbal***, ***Written***, ***Listening***, and ***Reading***.
- **Understanding Communication**: ***Skills***, ***Importance***, in ***Education***, in ***Work***… etc.
- **Communication Skills Improvement**

Communication Definition

Communication is a word of Latin origin ***Communico* or *communicare***, which means to **share**.

Communication *is defined as "**The process of understanding and sharing meaning**".*

- **Transmission** and interchange of facts, ideas , feelings or course of action.
- Most common medium of communication is **language** not only language **we use codes and symbols in order to communicate**.

Elements of Communication Process

- **Sender-** the person who originates the message and is therefore the information source (or encoder)
- **Receiver** the person to whom the message is communicated and who interprets or decodes the message (Destination).
- **Message** is the content or what is communicated.
- **Channel** is the carrier through/by which the message is transmitted to the receiver. The choice of the channel and the type of symbols is determined by the **situation**.

Elements of Communication Process

- **Feedback** the observation of the receivers response/reaction by the sender.
- **Environment** , is the atmosphere, physical and psychological, where you send and receive messages.
- **Context** of the communication interaction involves the setting, scene, and expectations of the individuals involved.
- **Interference** (Noise) is anything that blocks or changes the source's intended meaning of the message.

Characteristics of Effective Communications

Effective communication requires the *Sender* to:

- **Know the audience members and establish a rapport (علاقة/فهم/اتصال) with them.**
- **Choose an appropriate communication channel**
- **Speak at the level of the receiver**
- **Be interested in the subject**
- **Know the subject well**

Characteristics of Effective Communications

Effective communication requires the *Message* to be:

- **Relevant to the receiver needs**
- **Applicable to the situation**
- **Clear and concise**
- **Accurate**
- **Timely**
- **Meaningful**

Effective communication requires the *Channel* to be:

- **Affordable** (بأسعار معقولة، ميسور، متناول اليد)
- **Appropriate**
- **Attractive**

Characteristics of Effective Communications

Effective communication requires the *Receiver* to be:

- **Be aware, interested, and willing to accept the message**
- **Understand the message value**
- **Listen attentively**
- **Provide feedback**

Models of Communication

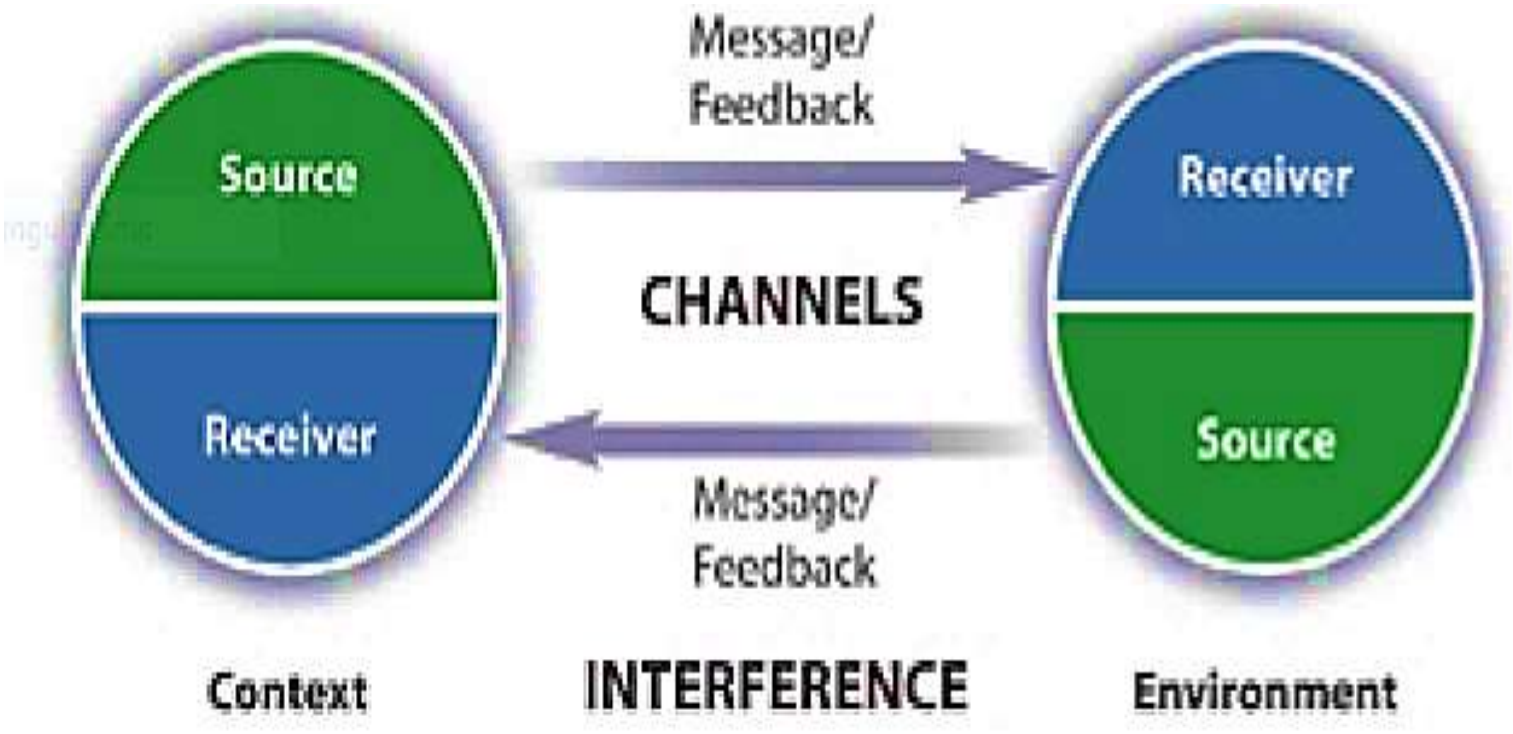
Transactional Model of Communication

- Rather than looking at the source sending a message and someone receiving it as two distinct acts, researchers often view communication as a **transactional process**, with **actions** often happening **at the same time**.

- The **distinction** between source and receiver is **unclear** in conversational turn-taking.

Models of Communication

Transactional Model of Communication



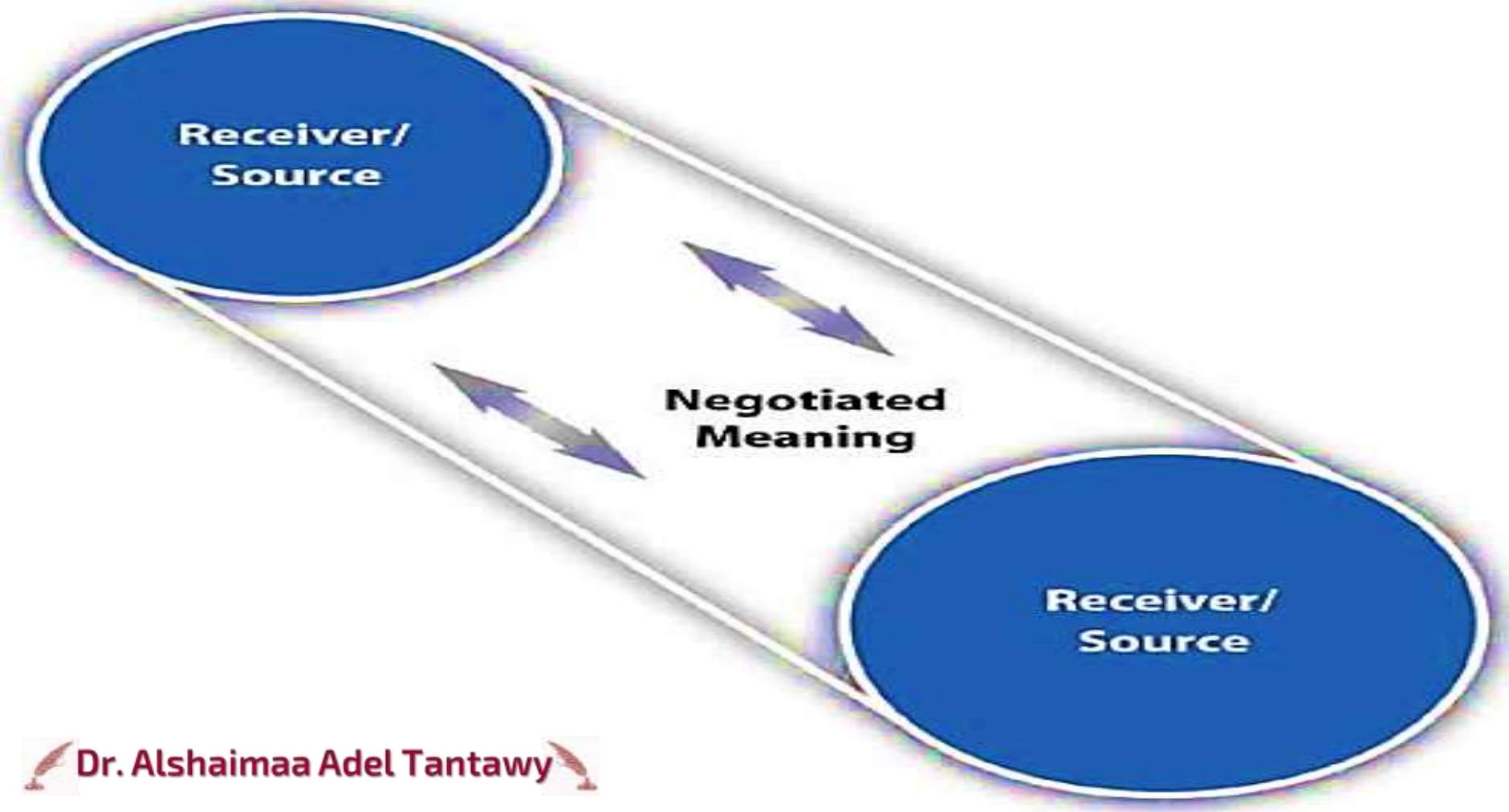
Models of Communication

Constructivist Model of Communication

- On the other hand; researchers have also examined the idea that we all construct our own interpretations of the message, *such that*; **"What I said and what you heard may be different"**.
- Focus on the **negotiated meaning**, or **common ground**, when trying to describe communication.

Models of Communication

Constructivist Model of Communication



Models of Communication

TRANSACTIONAL MODEL	OTHER MODELS
Used for interpersonal communication	Used for Intrapersonal, interpersonal, group or mass communications.
Senders and Receivers are known as Communicators, they interchange their roles	Senders and receivers are different people
Includes the role of context and environment	Role of context and environment are not mentioned in other models
Includes noise and communication barriers as factors	Not necessarily have the concept of noise
Talks about non-verbal communication	Ignores non-verbal communication
Simultaneous feedback	Feedback comes later in interaction model and is not included in linear model

Communication in Context

Intrapersonal Communication

- As you "**Talk with yourself**" you are engaged in intrapersonal communication.
- Intrapersonal communication involves **one person**; it is often called "**Self-talk**."
- Your intrapersonal communication can be positive or negative, and **directly influences** how you **perceive** and **react** to situations and communication with others.

Communication in Context

Interpersonal Communication

- Interpersonal communication normally involves **two people**, and can range from
  - **Friendly** and **very personal**

    (between Friends)

  to

  - **Formal** and **impersonal**.

    (at Work)

Communication in Context

Group Communication

- A dynamic process where a small number of people engage in a conversation.
- involving three to eight people.
- Factors *like* Age, Education, Sex, and Location to learn more about groups and their general Preferences as well as Dislikes.

Communication in Context

Public Communication

- **One person speaks/writes to a group of people**
- The speaker or writer may ask questions, and **engage** the audience in a discussion but the conversation dynamics are distinct from group communication, where **different rules apply**.

Communication in Context

Mass Communication

- Mass media is a powerful force in modern society and our daily lives, and is adapting rapidly to new technologies. Mass communication involves sending a single message to a large group.

- You can use multimedia as a visual aid or reference common programs, films, or other images that your audience finds familiar yet engaging.

Types of Communication Skills

Verbal

- Speaking (Oral)
- Written
- Listening
- Reading

Non Verbal

- Signs
- Symbols
- Body Language
- Facial expressions
- Touch
- Even style of clothing
- Variation in Voice Characteristics

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Types of Communication Skills

Verbal Communication (Speaking)

Meetings, Presentations, Workshops, In-person Interviews, Telephonic and Video conferencing.

- **Using Positive Language**
- **Using 'I' Statements**
- **Confidence *versus* Aggression**
- **Speaking Style**

Types of Communication Skills

Verbal Communication (Speaking)

Advantages

- Flexible
- Clarification
- Time
- Persuasion & control
- Formality
- Cost
- Convenient/reliable for Groups

Limitations

- Future ref not possible
- Not-effective if poor speaker
- Not suitable for lengthy details
- Misrepresentation
- Poor remembering

Types of Communication Skills

Written Communication

Email, Internal Business Memos, Formal Letters, Bulletin Boards, Posters, Brochures, Handouts, PPTs… etc.

- An effective tool to explain complex concepts and to issue instructions.
- Creates a paper trail for future reference and it also helps the legal teams of large companies do their job.

Types of Communication Skills

Written Communication

- This form of communication is **reliable**; it can be used to reach multiple individuals all at once; and **is the best way to transfer technical information**.

Formal language in written communication

- ❑ **Your personal relationship with the recipient**
- ❑ **The Communication Purpose**

Types of Communication Skills

Written Communication

Advantages

- Most wanted
- Permanent
- Legal evidence
- Accurate
- Suitable for lengthy and complicated

Limitations

- Limited only Literates (إجادة القراءة والكتابة)
- Delayed feedback
- Time consuming
- Costly
- Formal

Types of Communication Skills

Listening

- The most difficult communication skill to practice, listening implies that you not only hear what someone is saying but also **understand** the content, **decode** all the non-verbal signals and **filter** the message without bias or prejudice.
- **A company that listens effectively is one that is open to Ideas, Feedback, Innovations,**
  - has good organizational relationships, and
  - is willing to correct its mistakes and predictable marches forward.

Types of Communication Skills

Reading

- This is threatening to master simply because more and more people, especially young people, are spending less and less time reading.
- Many limit their ‘reading’ to social networking sites and instant messaging, while reading only when absolutely necessary.
- Yet, to be a successful student, employee, executive, manager or CEO, you need to master the art of reading simply because at least half your communication is in written format.

General *vs* Professional Communication

- **Professional Communication:** Use of effective language for transmission a technical, commercial, industrial… etc. message to achieve a predetermined purpose.

- **Professional Communication** concerned with business activities
  - characterized by certain formal elements
  - impartial (محايد) and objective
  - certain complex writing techniques

General *vs* Professional Communication

General Communication	Technical Communication
Contains a general message	Contains a technical message
Informal in style and approach	Mostly formal
No set pattern of communication	Follows a set pattern
Mostly oral	Both oral and written
Not always for a specific audience	Always for a specific audience
Doesn't involve the use of technical vocabulary or graphics, etc.	Frequently involves jargon, graphics, symbols… etc.

Skill to Communicate

- **Skill Definition**
  - The learned ability to bring about a predetermined result with maximum certainty and efficiency.
  - An ability to perform an activity in a competent manner.
  - The abilities that one owns
- **This ability to translate technical information to non-specialist is a key skill to any technical communicator.**

Key Communication Skills

- **Useful communication skills for building positive interpersonal relationships include:**
  - Active listening
  - Understanding non-verbal signals
  - Maintaining eye contact
  - Assertiveness/ Confidence
  - Being mindful of people's individual space
  - Using positive body language
- Dealing with different points of view.

Key Communication Skills

Personal awareness skills that help with communication include:

- Understanding the benefits of a positive attitude
- Awareness of how others perceive you
- Self-confidence
- Presentation - dressing appropriately for different occasions.

Communication Skills in Education

Building communication skills in education will help you:

- Understand and take in what's been said and taught
- Present your work in a clear way to teachers, from homework to reports
- Make presentations and speeches with more confidence

Communication Skills in Education

Building communication skills in education will help you:

- Ask questions that help you boost your understanding
- Progress with your team members and people in your project team
- Share your ideas or thoughts in a way that makes people want to listen to them.

Communication Skills in Work

Building Communication Skills at work will help you:

- Give **presentations** and do **reports** with increased **confidence**
- Have a great **phone manner** if you are talking to **customers** or clients.
- Send typo-free **emails** that match the **professional tone** of where you work
- Get on with your **manager** and people in your **team**

Communication Skills in Work

Building Communication Skills at work will help you:

- **Listen carefully to what you need to do, so you understand what's needed**
- **Network to find new opportunities.**
- **Share your ideas in a way that will be appreciated by co-workers**

Building Communication Skills

- Watch and learn from the body language of others
- Contribute ideas to a team project
- Volunteer to give a presentation
- Do practice job interviews at home
- Write a blog

Establishing Communication Skills

- Creating a good CV
- Writing E-mails
- Job Interviews

S.T.A.R Method

stands for Situation, Tasks, Action and Results

Top 5 Tips for Getting the Most out of STAR method

1. Be Prepared.
2. Be Specific.
3. Be Quantitative.
4. Be Concise.
5. Be Honest!

Communication Skills Improvement

There are specific things to do that can actually <u>improve your communication skills</u>:

1. Check your message before you hit send.
2. Who you are talking to matters.
3. Body language matters.
4. Be brief, yet specific.
5. Listen, listen, and listen.
6. Maintain a positive attitude and smile
7. Sometimes it's better to pick up the phone.
8. Think before you speak.
9. Treat everyone equally.
10. Write things down.

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